

Chapter 163-2

Liang Shi paused for a long while before continuing from her previous sentence: "I never thought anyone would ever... to me..."

But she got stuck halfway through.

She couldn't continue.

Compared to Xu Qingzhu's pure and passionate love, her bit of inferiority could only get stuck in her throat.

Like a thorn.

Liang Shi was neither pure nor passionate.

She was like a cup of tepid tap water, forever containing impurities.

Facing Xu Qingzhu, she couldn't say anything.

Words of defense, explanation, promises to make.

All gone.

What could she possibly say in the face of such love?

Anything she said would seem insignificant.

"Do you think that no one in this world would love you like this?" Xu Qingzhu asked.

Liang Shi closed her eyes. A tear fell as she slowly nodded.

Yes.

Who would love her like this?

The people who loved her had long since passed away.

Everyone being good to her was simply because she still had some small use value, or they only needed to give her a little something in return for her past kindness.

But in this relationship, Liang Shi felt she hadn't been up to par.

This was Liang Shi's first time in love.

Not romantic, not attentive, unable to understand her lover's heart.

Occasionally even a bit dense.

Xu Qingzhu had probably been angered to the point of coughing blood by her at certain moments.

Only to dissolve it alone with love.

She was clearly older than Xu Qingzhu, yet Xu Qingzhu always had to take care of her feelings.

"Why wouldn't there be?" Xu Qingzhu continued asking. "Don't you deserve it?"

Liang Shi was stunned.

After a long while, Liang Shi closed her eyes and said: "Because... I love myself too much."

//

The reason Liang Shi could detach herself from this relationship at any time was because she loved herself too much.

She was always in a defensive state.

Because she worried that Xu Qingzhu might meet her destined person and leave at any time, she had to prepare herself to leave at any moment.

Liang Shi's rationality told her she had to do this.

Because almost no one had ever made decisions for her since childhood, she always had to make her own decisions.

And take responsibility for those decisions.

Her grandparents were so old and could barely read—how could they be responsible for her life?

Being able to give her the love within their understanding was already good enough.

So her life seemed stable on the surface, but she had always listed out Plans A, B, C, and D.

There was always a Plan B.

The only time she had never considered the consequences, the only time she had thrown caution to the wind, was when she absolutely had to return here.

Because she wanted to see Xu Qingzhu.

At that time, she felt she really did love Xu Qingzhu very much.

But when the rules of this world began operating again, her love became calculating once more.

So compared to Xu Qingzhu, her love was truly insignificant—even too embarrassing to speak of.

But unexpectedly, after hearing her say this, Xu Qingzhu simply raised her hand to wipe away her own tears and said to her very seriously: "Then love yourself well. I'll love you."

After saying this, Xu Qingzhu added: "On the condition that you're not allowed to leave anymore."

How could Liang Shi possibly withstand this? One sentence from Xu Qingzhu made her burst into tears.

Afterward, Xu Qingzhu turned around and comforted her instead.

The two stayed in the office for who knows how long, until Xu Qingzhu's stomach growled. Looking at her watch, it was almost one o'clock.

About three hours had passed.

Liang Shi glanced at her belly, her nose feeling slightly sour. But her emotions had basically stabilized. Hearing Xu Qingzhu's stomach growl, she looked over curiously, reaching out her hand then pulling it back, repeating this several times.

Xu Qingzhu took her hand and placed it on her belly. Her gaze as she looked down at her stomach was very gentle: "The doctor said there won't be any movement for now. We'll have to wait a while."

Liang Shi's hand gently caressed her belly. "So our baby is in here?"

Xu Qingzhu nodded: "Yes."

"It feels so magical," Liang Shi said.

Xu Qingzhu: "....."

Xu Qingzhu probably didn't understand this feeling of hers.

Because in Liang Shi's previous understanding, two girls couldn't have children together.

But now, through the fusion of pheromones, they could conceive a child.

Was this perhaps the progress of technology?

And this little one was slowly growing in Xu Qingzhu's belly. In a few months, they would meet.

Liang Shi would once again have a blood bond.

A bond beyond just romantic love.

When Liang Shi and Xu Qingzhu walked out of the office holding hands, agent Chang Hui was no longer waiting at the door. She had sent Liang Shi a message saying she had something to do and left early.

She probably didn't want to be a third wheel¹.

Besides, having been in this industry for so long, she was very perceptive.

This floor had a direct elevator to the parking garage.

Liang Shi and Xu Qingzhu went straight to the garage to get the car. After fastening their seatbelts, Liang Shi asked Xu Qingzhu: "Do you want to eat out or at home?"

"Home," Xu Qingzhu said.

Liang Shi had no objections and drove home.

Footnotes:

¹ **Third wheel (電燈泡):** Literally "light bulb" in Chinese. This is slang for an unwanted third person who tags along with a couple, similar to the English expression "third wheel." The metaphor comes from the idea that a light bulb illuminates things that the couple might prefer to keep in the dark.